have a base page that defines the look of your site with some placeholder blocks for content. Regular pages then extend the base page and only declare the blocks that need overriding. I typically call my main parent page base.html. This main parent page contains all the boilerplate HTML that defines the look and feel of a site. Included in the boilerplate is a block named `content`, which is empty. Any other page on the site then extends the base page, declaring a `content` block that contains the details for that page.

For more complicated sites, you may want to have a couple of variations on the main page. A common pattern is to have a main page without navigation, a page that inherits from that with navigation, and then your actual site pages. Figure 3.4 shows an About page using this hierarchy.

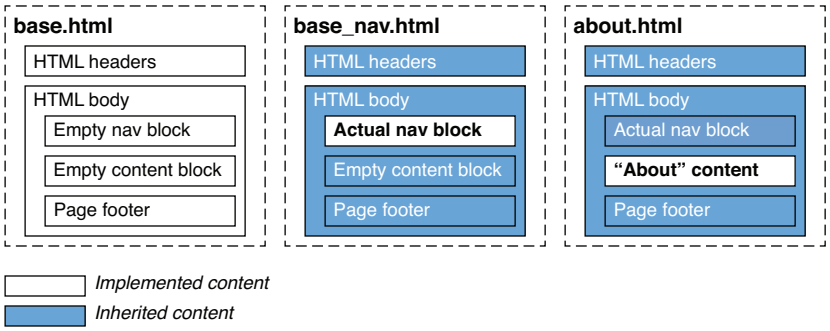


Figure 3.4 Page inheritance for component reuse

3.8.1 Writing a base template file

To put all this into practice let's write a parent page for your website. This page contains the HTML common to all pages on the site. It defines two blocks: one for the title area, and a second for content. Call the file base.html and put it with your other templates in the RiffMates/templates directory. Listing 3.15 shows example content for this parent. If you want prettier web pages, this is the place to insert code for your favorite web style framework, like Bootstrap or Tailwind.

Listing 3.15 Base HTML template for inheritance

```
<!-- RiffMates/templates/base.html -->
<!doctype html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <title>
    {% block title %}RiffMates{% endblock %}
  </title>
</head>
```